

CJ 540

WRITING RESEARCH

Professor Burke VanVleet Jr

SEARCHING FOR LITERATURE

Searches

Where

- Library Web Search
- Google Scholar

How

- Use Boolean Keywords
- Snowball Search



SEARCHING FOR LITERATURE

Keywords

criminal behavior among female college students.

- “crime” AND “female” AND “college students”

cohabitation among gay and lesbian couples.

- “gay” OR “lesbian” AND “cohabit*”



READING THE LITERATURE

Academic Journal Articles

- Read the Abstract – A summary of a research article
- Read the Introduction and Conclusion/Discussion
- Skim the article, noting section headings and tables and graphs
- Read the article in its entirety



READING THE LITERATURE

Academic Books

- Read the preface or introduction
- Read conclusion
- Read introduction/conclusions for relevant chapters
- Read the book in its entirety



READING THE LITERATURE

Evaluating Research Literature

- Theoretical Orientations
- Study Design:
 - Measurement
 - Research Questions
 - Sampling
- Methods



USING THE INTERNET WISELY

Use reliable, high-quality sources

Sources:

- Google (Scholar)
- Library

Data/Examples:

- Nationally-recognized Newspapers (LAT, NYT, CT, WP, WSJ)
- Government/Bureaucratic (.gov, Census, CDC, World Bank, CIA, HMD)



USING THE INTERNET WISELY

Evaluating quality of internet materials

- Who/What is the author of the website?
- Is the site advocating a particular point of view?
- Does the website give accurate and complete references?
- Are the data up-to-date?
- Are the data official?
- Is it a University research site?
- Do the data seem consistent with data from other sites?



WRITING SOCIAL RESEARCH

Use proper grammar and spelling

Use a style guide (ASA Style Guide)

Avoid Plagiarism:

Presenting someone else's words or thoughts as thought they were your own, constituting intellectual theft.

WRITING SOCIAL RESEARCH

Sections of the Report

Introduction

- Should outline the research question and why it is important
 - What is the research question?
 - What do we know about variable X? Why, logically, do you think it relates to Y?
 - What broad process does the relationship exemplify?

Review of the Literature

- Fit your research into the context of existing scientific knowledge.

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Sections of the Report

Study Design and Execution/Data & Methods

- Include the population, the sampling frame, the sampling method, the sample size, the data collection method, the completion rate, and the methods of data processing/coding and analysis.

Analysis and Interpretation

- The presentation, manipulation and interpretation of data analysis

Summary and Conclusions

- Don't review all findings
- Review significant findings in the context of the larger project and existing scientific research, review shortcomings and make suggesting for future research

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Sections of the Report

Going Public:

- Sending to an advisor, mentor, or knowledgeable scholar who can provide feedback for improvement
- Submitting to an academic journal or press
- Submitting report to organization
- Submitting for conference presentations